

August 13, 2026

Aetna
Provider Resolution Team
P.O. Box 14020
Lexington, KY 40512

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Kimiko Dooley (MRN MUSC2976653), Claim MUSC-75E9-1

Patient	Kimiko Dooley (DOB 1996-11-07)
MRN	MUSC2976653
Member ID / Group	AET817569447 / GRP-96846
Claim number	MUSC-75E9-1
Date of service	2026-07-04
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	Z34.90 — Encounter for supervision of normal pregnancy, unspecified
Denied amount	\$419.53
Denial code	CARC 16 / RARC N290 — Claim/service lacks information or has submission/billing error(s).
Appeal deadline	2027-01-25

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this Level 1 reconsideration on behalf of patient Kimiko Dooley (Member ID: AET817569447, Group: GRP-96846) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-75E9-1, covering a date of service of July 4, 2026, at MUSC Health Florence Medical Center. The claim was submitted on July 9, 2026, for CPT 99214 (office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity), billed at \$419.53, with a total denied amount of \$419.53. Aetna issued a denial on July 29, 2026, citing CARC 16 and RARC N290: "Missing/incomplete/invalid rendering provider primary identifier," with the payer remark that the claim cannot be adjudicated due to missing or invalid required data elements. MUSC Health respectfully disputes this denial and submits that the rendering provider's National Provider Identifier (NPI) was valid and on file at the time of submission.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Ms. Dooley is a 29-year-old established patient who presented on July 4, 2026, at MUSC Health Florence Medical Center for an outpatient encounter billed under place of service 22. The visit was rendered by Elena V. Castellanos, MD, whose NPI on record is 1881726354. The primary diagnosis reported on the claim is Z34.90 (encounter for supervision of normal pregnancy, unspecified), with a secondary diagnosis of J06.9. The level of service billed, CPT 99214, reflects a moderate-complexity established patient visit consistent with the clinical circumstances documented. The claim was submitted within five days of the date of service, well within standard timely filing parameters under the applicable coverage period of January 1, 2024, through December 31, 2026.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The sole stated basis for denial is CARC 16 / RARC N290, indicating that the rendering provider's primary identifier — the NPI — was missing, incomplete, or invalid. MUSC Health asserts that this denial does not reflect a clinical or coverage determination, but rather an administrative discrepancy that is correctable upon review. The NPI submitted for rendering provider Elena V. Castellanos, MD, is 1881726354. This NPI is an active, valid identifier registered in the National Plan and Provider Enumeration System (NPPES). HIPAA administrative simplification standards require that covered entities use the NPI as the standard provider identifier on all electronic transactions, and MUSC Health's billing systems are configured to transmit this identifier in the appropriate loop and segment of the 837P transaction set. To the extent that the identifier was not recognized during Aetna's adjudication process, MUSC Health respectfully requests that Aetna verify the NPI against the NPPES registry and reprocess the claim accordingly. No rebilling should be required when the identifier on the original claim is demonstrably valid and the denial is attributable to a processing or data-matching issue on the payer's end. Payers are generally obligated under applicable state and federal prompt-pay requirements to adjudicate clean claims in a timely manner and to provide a pathway for correction of administrative errors without requiring full resubmission where the underlying information is accurate.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Aetna conduct a thorough review of the original claim, confirm the validity of NPI 1881726354 for rendering provider Elena V. Castellanos, MD, and reprocess Claim MUSC-75E9-1 for payment at the applicable contracted rate. The allowed amount previously calculated was \$191.37, and MUSC Health requests that payment be issued in that amount without further delay. Supporting documentation, including the rendering provider's NPI confirmation and the original claim detail, is enclosed with this submission via Availity Disputes and Appeals. Should Aetna require any additional information to complete this review, please contact MUSC Health's Revenue Cycle department at the contact information provided on the accompanying cover sheet. This appeal is submitted within the 180-day reconsideration window, with a deadline of January 25, 2027.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record